

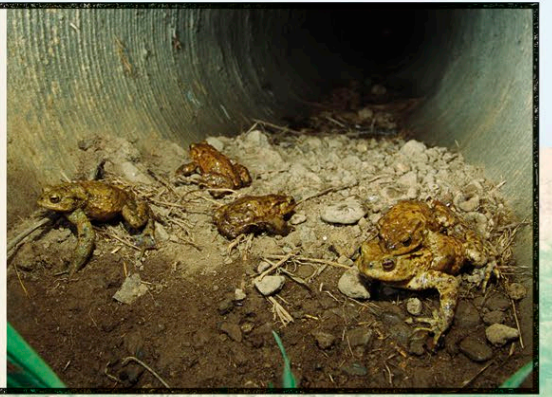
Breeding pools

Like most amphibians, toads lay their eggs in pools of water. The female common toad lays her eggs in two long strings, each up to 16 ft (5 m) long. The eggs will hatch into aquatic larvae, or tadpoles.



Mass migration

Each springtime, large numbers of common toads emerge from hibernation and travel to their breeding pools. In some places, special toad-crossing tunnels have been built to help them cross roads safely.



Mating toads

When mating in ponds, the male toad grabs the larger female around the waist just behind her front legs and then fertilizes the strings of eggs as they are released into the water.

ASIA

Temperate belt

The common toad is found throughout much of Europe—in the temperate belt south of the cold polar regions and north of hotter Africa and Asia. It lives most of its life away from water, hiding in damp, shady places, returning to the water only to breed.

Bulging eyes

The large eyes of a common toad give it good night vision. Common toads are most active at night, using the cover of darkness to hunt for prey.

Tongue attack

The toad catches invertebrate prey, such as slugs, snails, and spiders, with a long, sticky-tipped tongue that shoots out of its mouth at lightning speed.

